

1872-73

MAY 1872

The Republican Party splits. A new Liberal Republican group nominates Horace Greeley as its presidential candidate. They call for honest government and an end to military intervention in the South.

MAY 1872

Congress passes an Amnesty Act, allowing most former Confederates to seek public office.

NOVEMBER 1872

President Grant is reelected.

SEPTEMBER 1873

The Panic of 1873 is triggered by the failure of a major bank, Jay Cooke & Co., because of problems with its railroad investments. The banking crisis and a major economic depression last for the next five years.



Panic of 1873: start of five-year depression